INFOGRAM

A model for writing a thesis that holds together

I built a model from what I learned about thesis writing: one argument structure, five common problems to avoid, and a diagnostic scorecard to check the work.

PART 1

The general argument structure

The argument narrows from a wide context down to the evidence, then opens out again into the answer, its impact and what comes next.

1 **Top funnel**
The broad context the whole study sits inside.

2 **Research gap**
What the funnel leaves unanswered.

3 **Research question**
The single question that closes the gap.

4 **What's included & excluded**
In scope · Out of scope

5 **Method**

6 **Evidence**

THEN IT OPENS OUT

The answer
What the evidence says to the question.

Impact
Why the answer matters.

Further research
Opportunities the work opens up.

PART 2

Five problems to avoid

A

Word fluff

Words that take up space without adding meaning. Cut them.

B

Weak boundaries & scope creep

Edges of the study left loose, so it drifts beyond what the question can support.

C

Unverified mechanism

Claiming how or why something happens without evidence that shows it.

D

Scale disconnect

Evidence gathered at one scale used to support claims at another.

E

Hedging, used to keep claims honest

Match the strength of each claim to the strength of its evidence. Hedge where the evidence is thin, and stay direct where it is solid.

PART 3

The diagnostic scorecard

Score each line from 1 (weak) to 5 (strong). The lowest scores show where to revise first.

The research gap is clear	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
The research question closes that gap	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Included and excluded are stated, with no scope creep	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
The method fits the question	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
The mechanism is verified by the evidence	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Evidence and claims sit at the same scale	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Claims are hedged honestly	○ ○ ○ ○ ○